

Armand Budan, Guadeloupean painter in Bourron-Marlotte

Descendant of a wealthy family from the Loire Valley, who became owners of sugar cane plantations, Armand Budan was born in Guadeloupe in 1827. He taught the painting of “exotic flowers” to young girls on this island, then stayed in the United States, where he met his wife. After painting several wall decorations in various buildings in Guadeloupe and Martinique, then publishing the reference work *La Guadeloupe Pittoresque*, richly illustrated by him, Armand Budan (1827-1874) tried his luck in Paris in the early 1860s. In that arts capital, he was selected to present his works at the *Salon de Peinture*, from 1863 to 1867. Few of his paintings have unfortunately reached us.

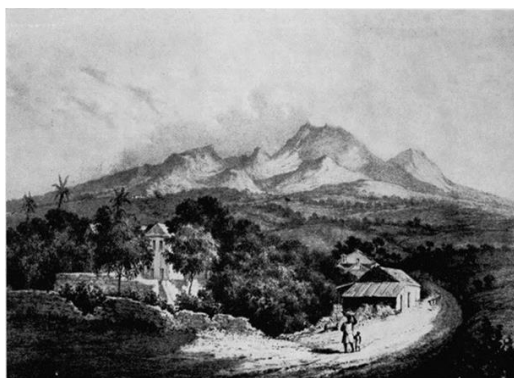
During this period, it is likely that Budan was intrigued by the fame acquired by artists around the Fontainebleau Forest and that he made the decision to move into a house at the *Pavé du Roy*, in Bourron-Marlotte (village close to Fontainebleau), where he lived for several years, with his wife and three children.

Already attracted by photography, Budan then opened a photography store in Paris.

Probably towards the end of the 1860s, he returned to the Antilles, where he died in Saint-Pierre de la Martinique in 1874. Armand Budan leaves the memory of a talented painter and one of the first photographers of the Antilles. A street is named after him in Anse-Bertrand, Guadeloupe.



Armand Budan in his studio
(private collection)



Vue de la Soufrière, gravure extr. de l'album, *La Guadeloupe pittoresque*,
publié par Armand Budan en 1863.

View of the Soufrière volcano in *La Guadeloupe Pittoresque*



*Bouquet of flowers in front of
a landscape (Musée des
Beaux-Arts de Guadeloupe)*

A more detailed article will be published in a future Bulletin of the Amis de Bourron-Marlotte.